

Another year, another torrent of technology! The end of this year leaves us breathless with the number of new and path-breaking technologies that have emerged across fields, from processors to motherboards and graphics cards all the way to operating systems and image processing software.

This year has been momentous in that the amount of processing power that's available on the desktops makes it possible for even home users to do most things that were earlier in the realm of professionals. The 2 GHz processor made its debut. Memory and hard disk subsystems became more powerful thanks to DDR-RAM and 15,000-rpm drives. This trend of packing more power into the machine is most evident in the field of entertainment and gaming. The processing power on today's graphics cards is truly enormous. Realism is the catchphrase here—even skin and hair on the game characters of today is animated realistically, resulting in a truly stunning experience.

Now even 'ordinary' PCs are equipped with the power and the tools to create home videos and communicate with other PC users over broadband connections—this is evident from the fact that almost all operating systems today integrate a basic video editing software and other audio ripping and conversion applications.

The year 2001 also witnessed the maturing of personal devices such as handheld computers, digital cameras and MP3 players. With more processing power, a wider range of features and slick looks, these devices truly liberate a new generation of mobile users from their desktops.

Couple these developments with the falling prices of hardware and components, and you have a buyer's market out there.

The Zero1 Awards reflect these changes in the IT industry and felicitates the products that were instrumental in bringing about this change.

What follows is the crème de la crème of hardware and software and the technologies that proved to be the beacons of innovation in the past year.

Ladies and Gentlemen, the Zero1 Awards!

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